

Aneesha Sampath

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SUMMARY

I am a fourth-year Ph.D. candidate specializing in speech processing, with a focus on developing emotion-aware speech recognition and generation models. My ultimate goal is to create efficient, socio-emotionally intelligent AI.

EDUCATION

University of Michigan <i>Ph.D. Candidate in Artificial Intelligence</i> <i>M.S. in Computer Science</i> Research: Computational Human AI Lab (Prof. Emily Mower Provost)	Ann Arbor, MI Expected May 2028 May 2025
Carnegie Mellon University <i>B.S. in Artificial Intelligence</i> <i>Concentration: Language Technologies; Minor: Drama</i> Research: MultiComp Lab (Prof. Louis-Philippe Morency)	Pittsburgh, PA May 2023

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Honda Research Institute <i>Research Scientist Intern</i> Building socially intelligent full-duplex speech-to-speech models	San Jose, CA August 2026 – Present
University of Michigan <i>Graduate Research Assistant</i> - CHAI Lab (Computational Human AI) with Prof. Emily Mower Provost - Building emotion-oriented speech foundation models	Ann Arbor, MI August 2023 – Present
Carnegie Mellon University <i>Undergraduate Research Assistant</i> - MultiComp Lab (Multimodal Machine Learning) with Prof. Louis-Philippe Morency - Recovering annotator rating distributions from an aggregated label in emotion recognition	Pittsburgh, PA August 2021 – May 2023
Microsoft Core Search & AI <i>Applied Research Intern</i> - Developed deep learning models for Bing search result title generation (+3% quantity; +60% quality in new titles) - Designed a new dataset for Bing title generation with generative models and evaluated on two baseline models	Mountain View, CA May 2022 – August 2022

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Microsoft <i>Software Engineer Intern</i> Designed and implemented querying language to integrate an internal monitoring tool into Jupyter Notebooks.	Redmond, WA May 2021 – August 2021
Google <i>Software Engineer Intern</i> Conceptualized and implemented full-stack web application from scratch as part of a team of three interns.	New York, NY May 2020 – August 2020

LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE

University of Michigan AI Laboratory <i>NLP Day Conference Organizer</i> Student co-director for the University of Michigan’s NLP Day conference	Ann Arbor, MI May 2026 – Present
Computer Science and Engineering Graduate Student Organization <i>Admissions Committee Student Representative</i> - Represent the student voice on admissions-related initiatives and organize admissions events - Work with AI faculty admissions committee to train current PhD students to give feedback on AI applications	Ann Arbor, MI May 2024 – May 2026

- Evaluated undergraduate students' research presentations, selected finalists, and provided project feedback

PUBLICATIONS

- P1. "What You Feel Is Not What They See: On Predicting Self-Reported Emotion from Third-Party Observer Labels", El-Tawil, Y.*, **Sampath, A.***, Provost, EM., in *ICASSP 2026-2026 IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*. IEEE, 2026.
- P2. "SEER: The Span-based Emotion Evidence Retrieval Benchmark", **Sampath, A.**, Aran, O., Provost, EM., Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: IJCNLP-AACL 2025.
- P3. "Efficient Finetuning for Dimensional Speech Emotion Recognition in the Age of Transformers", **Sampath, A.***, Tavernor, J.*, Provost, EM., in *ICASSP 2025-2025 IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*. IEEE, 2025.
- P4. "Beyond Binary: Multiclass Paraphasia Detection with Generative Pretrained Transformers and End-to-End Models." Perez, M., **Sampath, A.**, Niu, M., Provost EM., in Interspeech 2024.
- P5. "SeedBERT: Recovering Annotator Rating Distributions from an Aggregated Label", **Sampath, A.**, Lin, V., Morency, LP., AAI-UDM Workshop, 2023.